

CEDRIC PRICE SUPPLEMENT

INTRODUCTION

For some years AD has been publishing schemes, articles and comments by Cedric Price as one of the prime movers on the radical architecture scene. However, much of his work still remains unpublished and much of the published work requires rethinks and updated commentaries.

To provide a complete picture of his work and ideas, we begin this month a series of supplements which will appear at intervals over the next year. These pages can be taken out of the magazine, filed, recollated, added to or thrown away by the reader; there is space allowed for the reader's own comments and filing code, thus allowing the feature to become a flexible, user-serviced information pool in the best Cedric Price tradition. The presentation is very straight; Price's work lacks strong visual

impact. Unlike most other current radicals (and reactionaries) he is consciously anti-style - sometimes even at the expense of comprehensibility. His drawings have an expressionless aesthetic reminiscent of engineers' working drawings with fine lines and dead pan presentation which, like Le Corbusier's free hand drawings, begin to create a powerful imagery of their own. Standard forms, elevations and perspectives mean little in the terms of Price's work: his plans are kits of parts and circuit diagrams; his details are catalogue specifications. He presents a complete and conscious reversal of current procedure, disposing of the traditional constraints of the pre-electric age and stripping *architecture* down to a *service* with *servicing*. He is perhaps the ultimate intellectual services engineer dispensing self-space, self-service, flexible, expendable renewable non-environments - liberating man

from existing rigid structuring while still allowing him to operate within that set-up. Services are toys, things to play with, have fun with. They are all-providing. They are education/information, shelter, transport, baby-sitters, social exchange. They can be controlled by the receiver to suit his needs, receptivity and mood. They are continually available, easily and at any stage. The *building* could be an existing structure, a clip-on mock tudor facade, an inflatable or a bicycle shed: although that is not to disregard the fact that in some cases a building in the traditional sense may be a valid solution. His business is problem-solving within the context of user choice, the freedom from environmental constraints and the general improvement of the quality of life; and that's what it's all about.

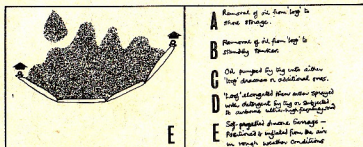
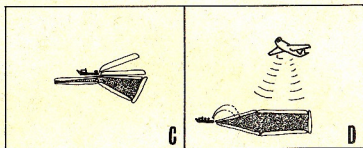
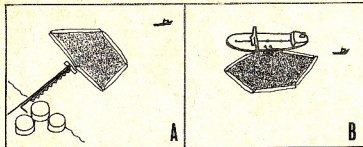
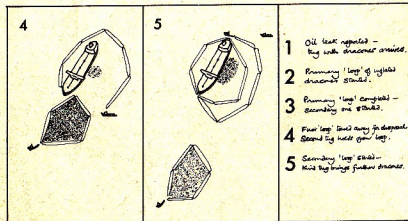
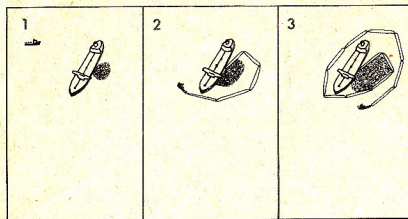
P.M.

FORWARD

To introduce this series I have selected together with Peter Murray a slightly ragged and rum collection which nevertheless establishes the majority of themes for subsequent collections. However, in order to avoid your having to accept such themes, I am merely indexing the schemes under code letters, the definition of which will not be given until the end of the series.

(I have always thought the untitled stamp albums and scrapbooks far more useful). I realise there is an element of horror comic about all this - if architects' shortfalls were more widely known, then who knows, our individual productivity might be collectively accelerated. I for one would like to know more about local authority housing roofs that, under certain circumstances, can fly.

C.P.



67 72 B.45 1 25

Surface oil containment

Originally designed to enhance the quality of seaside villages by keeping their beaches clean rather than painting their front doors, this project occurred just before the Torrey Canyon oil tanker disaster off the south coast of UK.

As a result, further work was done in the final treatment of the oil. The dracones employed were standard products already in production for the transport of fresh water etc. whereas the linking fringe required further detailed design.

COMMENT

This scheme was developed further by National Research and Development Council and Dunlop (The manufacturers of Dracones) by introducing an oil mixture into the dracone itself. I was not called in: "why should an ARCHITECT be interested". The whole question of disaster planning is unlikely even to be satisfactorily solved in physical terms. Only when Agadir and Aberfan are recognised as likely events will the necessary legislation and management enable 'disaster' planning to afford sufficient anticipatory design effort and product.

PNEUMATICS - A KEY TO VARIABLE HYBRID STRUCTURING

After seeing Mr. Bird's impressive achievements and hearing Mr. Lundy's enthusiasm I wish to introduce a note of constructive pessimism. Pessimistically, I consider that the application - in the field of structures - of pneumatic techniques is too involved with solving normal structural and shelter problems. While the intermittent enclosure of swimming pools or protection of traditional construction work is extremely useful, such applications, if too widespread, can well result in the following actions which are detrimental to increasing the development of

lished can individual groups - in my case architects and physical planners - make accurate and substantiated demands on pneumatic technology. At this stage of the conference I list some aspects of this technology which are of particular interest to me as an architect:

- Multi-membrane construction which enables variable pressurisation and containment (cf. paper by R. Szilard).
- The availability and performance specification of transparent membranes.
- The control of light and radiation by both membranes, intermembrane construction and contained gases or liquids (cf. papers by R. Szilard and N. Laing).

example of the advantage of co-ordinated use of air within such structures. Methods of cleaning and movement related to the whole or part of the structure should also be included.

In the past major urban congregation areas were determined by the location of a large permanent structure providing mass accommodation or shelter such as the Roman Circus, the Mediaeval Cathedral, the Market Hall and the Sports Stadium. With the use of air structures such permanence is not required and so the additional restrictions of the fixed site should now be avoided. In effect, large air structures can enable planners to reverse the pattern of traditional

67 72 D5 2 24

Paper given at 1st International Colloquium on Pneumatic Structures Stuttgart

The title and content was chosen because it was felt that there was a danger of a new form of structural classicism being applied to air structures. In addition the paper dealt with the fragmentation and resultant isolation of current research and development while warning against too much 'ad-hocery'.

pneumatic technology:

- 1) Over-emphasis may be given to the static siting of air structures.
- 2) Direct cost comparisons with traditional structures may be made.
- 3) The fixed-period accommodation available with air structures may only be exploited for disaster or random-use of air structures.

All these actions can retard the investigation of new applications requiring improved and more complex air-structures. In addition the development of new materials and fabrication techniques should be related to new applications rather than concentrate on the perfection of existing applications since these very applications are still extremely arbitrary.

While space exploration and defence programs provide a valuable technical "spin-off" of the development air-structure technology, its very peculiarity is likely to restrict, in the near future, the technological advance of air structuring related to civil and social activities. Too many architects and designers wait to see what NASA and various Defence projects will produce. This conference must increase the content and frequency of exchange between scientists, engineers, manufacturers, architects, planners and social administrators. An immediate task could be to agree on the semantic definition of the various structures and systems we are now discussing (air-supported structures; air-inflated structures; air structures; pneumatic membrane structures; sealed pneumatic structures).

In this paper, reference to air structures includes air-supported and air-inflated structures, together with air-controlled and air-moved structures. In addition, we must keep mutually aware of the alteration of attitudes of authorities and others to the employment of air structures. In September 1965 the Department of Architecture and Civic Design of the Greater London Council refused to license a high-pressure air-beam structure for temporary use as a place of public entertainment on the grounds that it constituted merely "a tent without poles or frame". In December 1965 the same department of the G.L.C. were prepared to consider the use of the identical structure on receipt of calculations related to stability. Only when a continuous exchange is estab-

- d) The containment of granular substances between membranes to control humidity, sound transference etc.
 - e) The capacity of controlled air movement through the material of the membranes. Such a possibility enables changes in the normal methods of foul air evacuation.
 - f) Multi-layer bonding enabling variable cell construction. Such hybrid construction can enable the simultaneous use of high pressure sealed volumes and low pressure air-supported volumes.
 - g) Ultra-sonic bonding enabling an increased variation of membrane material. An increased use of various materials is urgently required not only to enable varying structural performance specifications to be met but also to achieve varying textural qualities.
 - h) Further information on the performance of high and low pressure structures in movement. The existing U.K. inflatable vehicle transporter which both protects the vehicle and propels it on the Hovercraft principle is an example of this. Movement must include the employment of the Hovercraft or Ground Effect Machine (G.E.M.) principle.
 - i) Self-packing, on deflation, of large volume membranes.
 - j) A new method of costing air-structures which is related to the variation of use and not merely material and unit plant cost. Any mechanical plant, pumps, blower etc. must be accepted as a structural element.
- The variation and individual control of volumes singly or in combination enables the separation of membranes related to the elimination of particular adverse conditions (cf. *papers by R. Szilard*).
- As *roofs, walls and floors* no longer exist in the conventional sense, their pneumatic equivalents no longer need to provide the additive structural support normally required. Only collective stability is required and the air one breathes can become the major structural force. This being so, the interior fittings or divisions of such structures become relatively more *permanent* (see the interior of Lundy/Bird US Atomic Energy Commission's travelling exhibit).
- Movement of such internal parts must also be investigated. The use of air-pallets for such intermittent movement is extremely valid. The use of an air-conditioning plant as the structural pressure feed is only one

urban congregation and servicing needs found in existing towns or cities. In new proposed urban settlements such nodes need no longer be permanent generators of fixed urban patterning.

These of air structures to provide short-term small and medium sized social facilities enables the siting of short-term mobile housing to be independent of towns offering similar facilities.

Air structures are already used to provide industrial production space particularly where the demand for such space is likely to fluctuate. Thus in effect we already have the mobile factory, but it must be further developed and its potential further exploited.

Work on disaster control and emergency planning has, over the past years, produced a wide range of pneumatic appliances and applications such as *fabric dams, dracones, vehicular hover-pads and GEMs* or hovercraft. However, such uses of air structures have not yet been seen as a method of reducing the dependence of emergency planning. That is, they have not been viewed as a potential asset to society enabling rapid yet variable control and communication to be achieved. Such realisation, backed by increasing design and development work, can enable air structures to contribute to a higher degree of sensitivity in society's continuous control of the physical environment.

This conference and the possibilities of future exchange that it has created must assist in establishing new priorities for future work. While I accept the fact that development of present projects is by no means perfect, a desire to achieve greater accuracy in the immediate tasks must not impair our realisation of the future potential.

Pneumatics, as far as partial or total structuring are concerned, are likely to stagnate unless this is realised. The field of valid application has scarcely been touched.

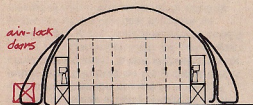
The determination of the extent, interaction and location of activities that require buildings is no longer a sufficient brief.

The quantitative assessment of the valid social life related to particular location must also be made and designed for.

This then is the major role for air structures now and in the future.

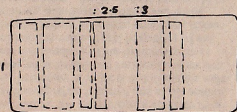
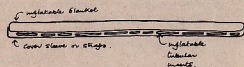
COMMENT

This paper though rather superficial nevertheless acted as a generator for much of the work done with Frank Newby on subsequent air structures research. The social aspect mentioned was considered irrelevant by most of the delegates at the Colloquium and many authorities since. However, there is now more co-operation at least in individual countries than in 1967.



Circorama cinema

An earlier inflatable scheme in which a separate pressurised 'air corset' is used for stability. Rejected on fire risk grounds.



Plan - projection onto screen

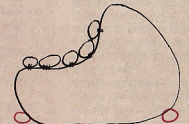
VARIABLE INFLATABLE FLOOR 'INFLAFLOOR'



Projection - diam of sphere to base
2:1



DUMBELL



SECTION under pressure

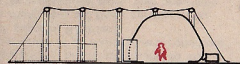
Large sphere with mini-spheres attached as required. Mutual adhesion requires the large sphere to be inflated with 1 point!

SATELITE



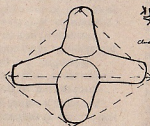
Passenger coach

Produced through annoyance with both the superficiality of coach design and also the volumetric waste of empty coaches in storage and transportation. An exercise in hybrid structuring including multi-pressured air structures. Utilisation of traction plant for air-conditioning and pressurisation. A development of the HAG HOLE 'concertina' principle.



Fun palace - pilot project

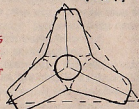
The major shelter element in this kit of parts consisting of an 'air inflated framework' containing an air supported structure enabling a variety of activities requiring both unlimited and limited access to take place under controlled yet temporary artificial environmental conditions.



4 lobes (condition)

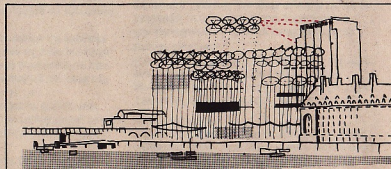
similar to
concrete
breakwaters

Projection - length of sides of air - water of air at 1 and 2 point
4:75:1:75

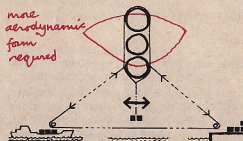


Plan or side (back) elevation

BREAKWATER

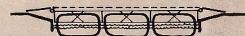


South Bank Fairground



Controlled balloon lift

A further example of using inflated structures in groups. In this case the helium filled balloons become a controllable sky hook enabling off/shore 2 way loading of heavy goods where the construction of a port would be unjustified.



Air bridge

Use of series of restrained inflated bags - see also Surface Oil Containment and South Bank Fair.

63 72 B45 3 23

Inflatable structures. 1963-64

(See also Archigram No. 6.)

COMMENT

The passenger coach is a great conceit comparable with the mobile wedding cake. The air bridge was found wholly feasible by the Romans using pig skins.

The cinema and pilot fun palace shelter have both been developed.

The most interesting project is the controlled balloon lift as an alternative to permanent peripheral land based facilities. It has been used in Canada for clearing lumber with second-hand Cardington balloons although Goodyear's giant logging balloon boomed. I think it a good idea and am working on it.

Inflatable furniture 1964

All four pieces to be made by Christmas decorations manufacturer on existing plant. Low cost and short life assumed. Prototype worked.

COMMENT

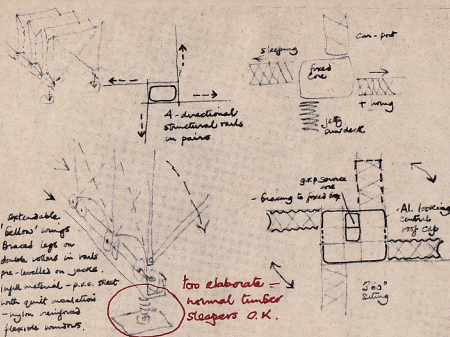
The increased range of gas-imperious materials together with the widened range of jointing and bonding techniques makes this game great fun. I ignored the necessity of ground anchorage and friction encouragement.

Controlled balloon - supported fair ground, Sound Bank London 1964

In order to accommodate a variable set of short-life platforms, stairways, ramps etc. which would be continuously re-arranged and re-directed. The idea for the fair was Felix Topolski's. Helium filled balloons inter-connected in six directions and anchored vertically to ground and horizontally to adjacent Shell tower block.

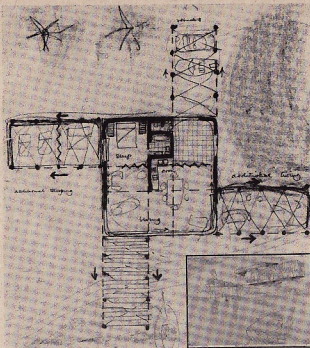
COMMENT

Controlled balloon lifting is in its infancy despite all the lessons that can be learnt from Cardington.



too elaborate -
normal timber
sleepers O.K.

Minimal soil storage requirement - sand, gravel 'stepped' etc.



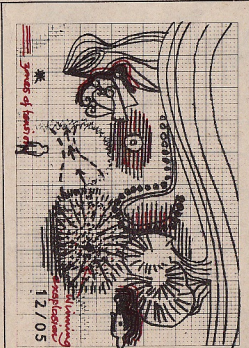
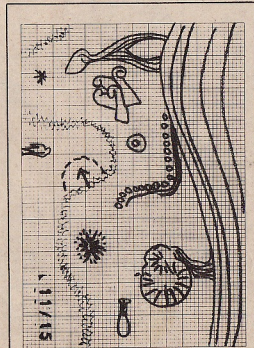
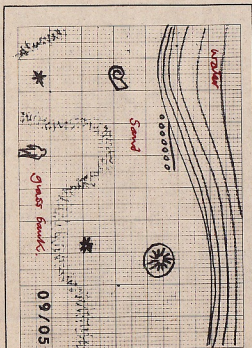
60 61 AB1 4 22

Hag Hole

A sketch scheme for a truck transportable week-end house to be located on a beach in North Wales. Variable volumetric demands had to be combined with maximum week-day security. Rail-track-sleeper principle of foundations was combined with sliding folding 'concertina' extensions.

COMMENT

Rather a stodgy way to spend a weekend by the sea. The introduction of the air conditioner, tape-player and refrigerator to the car has made this a bit of a mammoth.



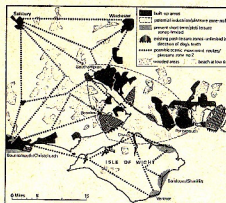
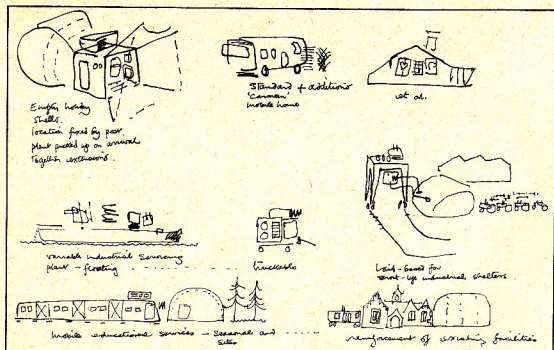
68 X14 DCA 5 X

Tasmania beach party AASA Convention of Creativity, Hobart

An open invitation was given to meet on an enormous empty beach south of Hobart. No instructions were given and no talk delivered - merely buckets and spades were made available. Some threw sticks into the sea then wandered away. Those who stayed ranged from quiet girls making gentle elaborate castles to Paul Ritter constructing a kiln for glass making. The scale plans show progress at the times listed. Despite the beach being several miles long, all activity was grouped, although cross conversation was minimal. Tension mounted as territorial rights were infringed and open hostility resulted.

COMMENT

A delightful example of the constipation of intelligent professionals when put out of operational context. The 'winners' were the four quiet men who drilled a thirty foot hole, dynamited it and presented me with a colour instamatic photograph of the explosion - at least I think they did.



Restrictions to be lifted

All physical planning restrictions including: road, rail and other transport routes other than national. Access points - type size and frequency - to existing routes. Preservation for cultural, historic etc. reasons. Aesthetic control for new buildings. Land use control including industrial and commercial development. Compulsory purchase orders. Plot ratio and height controls. Other restrictions to be removed include: particular privileges related to Crown Lands and War Department property. Present rights of the Forestry Commission. Clean air and water pollution Acts (part). Farm subsidies - both for capital expenditure and production. National Parks Act. Mineral rights. Common Lands law. Flight path restrictions - not national or international. Fisheries Acts. Wildlife Acts. Housing subsidies as at present applied to 'permanent' investment. Major public works grants. Direction of industry of labour. LOB (Location of Office Bureau). Local

radio and TV frequency control. Sunday Observance Act. Countryside Commission related to the areas.

Controls - physical or legislative - that would need to be retained to enable normal relationships with the rest of the UK.

National and international control of flight paths, radio frequencies and power lines. Parts of Clean Air and Pollution Acts related to health. All Ministry of Agriculture and Ministry of Health anti-disease legislation. Existing national physical links. National policy on immigration - however odious.

New controls or legislation required to enable Non-Plan to function.

New legislation would be required in relation to: off-shore development; foreign investment and movement of money and capital goods; land tenure and the reform or substitution of 'freehold'. Major standard and discretionary grants made by central govern-

ment to local authorities must be stopped first, since it is these more than anything else which perpetuate urban size and structure in irrelevant forms. Similarly, agricultural subsidies must go since these again originate 'rural' land use patterning long before the planners locate a 'green belt'. In addition, various central government aid programmes, such as those for 'development areas', provide the causation for physical development plans, and not the other way round.

Finally, the likely re-organization of local government into even larger, more autonomous 'city regions', will further aggravate the assumed self-contained quality of regional planning responsibilities. Therefore, in these areas no such re-organization - on the lines of city regions - must be allowed to take place. Other, largely post war legislation, which has acted against social mobility such as housing subsidies and redundancy payments, must be terminated.

69 X15 A12 6 X

Non Plan

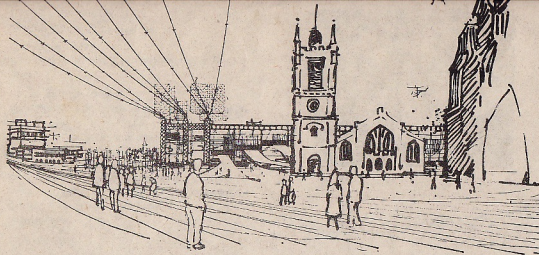
An experiment in freedom

Originally part of group project with Reyner Banham, Pual Barker and Peter Hall. Caused through growing annoyance at the positively anti-social implications of present physical planning policy and legislation in UK. AD article * details CP's detailed consideration of all four 'test-bed' sites investigated by all authors in New Society.

* AD 5/69.

COMMENT

I am still working on all this. It was, of course, misunderstood by the NIW3 wine and food socialists who considered that it marked capitulation to all those vile bodies of greed, wealth and privilege - then they retired behind their well painted brass-knocked yellow front doors. More worrying has been the occasional use of the phrase "Non-Plan" to justify rather slovenly thinking in extremely tightly planned social conceits such as Milton Keynes. Please note that rich people are the only ones who can afford to live in slums - castles, water-mills etc.



1. Combined heli and hover port.
2. Arterial communication : moving walkways linked to vehicular access; parking below.
3. Short-stay and emergency accommodation together with small cell offices and terrace.
4. Rest rooms, dining rooms, bars etc.
5. Pontoons supporting additional amenity areas for members.
6. Conference centre.
7. Open air exhibition area related to 6.
8. Variable public parliamentary information and exhibition hall. Information screens above.
9. Major enclosed area containing the Chambers, large committee rooms, and providing public access both internal and with 7 and 12. This area has direct contact with 10.
10. Small committee rooms and parliamentary offices with library below.
11. Public access walkways (variable).
12. Tube station.
13. Public square banked up on one side with tensioned blinds providing partial bad weather protection.
14. Members' long-term housing.
15. Westminster Abbey and St Margaret's.
16. River Thames.
17. Westminster Bridge.

PUBLIC

EXCHANGE



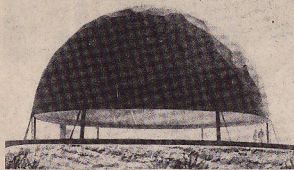
65 X15 BD3

Pop-up Parliament, Westminster, London

On an assumption that Parliament had to remain exactly where it is, this project proposed the demolition of the existing Palace of Westminster and replacement with the structure illustrated. Produced at a time when several MP's had detailed the pathetic cramped squalor in which they had to work. A great deal of on and off-site electronic equipment would be needed to justify continued use of this extremely tight democratically quaint site. In any case, a life of 30-40 years was considered suitable for the new structure. Westminster Square is turned into an enormous amphitheatre hopefully directed towards the video-information screens linked to all aspects of Parliamentary work. There was a clear intention to encourage public contact with the group activities undertaken by members while retaining privacy for individual members.

COMMENT

The sketches by Colbert were entirely based on discussion with him and the plan. I enjoyed seeing what he came up with. A rather static Fun Palace type animal which could, had it been built or at least budgeted for, given a few people the clue to the real usefulness of a Thameside site - which is not to legislate for West Hartlepool. The Architects Journal's only criticism was about the total absurdity of my even imagining that hovercraft would be quiet enough to be allowed on the upper Thames. The opportunity to express discontent or disgust would be so great as to render CS gas a luxury.



ACCOMMODATION

Auditorium Approximately 250 temporary seats arranged on four tiers with provision for random movement during intervals, at each level and also at the upper peripheral ambulatory level. The stage accommodated an orchestra of up to 14 pieces and access for a grand piano.

Exhibition Space. Approx. 11,500 sq ft on five levels.

Construction and materials Outer and inner domes of reinforced plastic (an adapted Radome - Buckminster Fuller). The latter constructed of scribed panels enabling further area adjustments during the initial acoustic testing on site. Background lighting and heating elements housed between the two translucent domes. Control for the raising and adjustment of the domes behind the stage baffle. The flooring of the auditorium and ambulatory made of porous in-situ concrete of hard tennis courts. The stage and baffle of in-situ concrete with a granolithic finish.

OPERATION

Auditorium

Mechanical Dome supported on 4 linked hydraulic jacks giving a perimeter clearance of 8'6" when raised. Second discontinuous 'domes' consisting of panels capable of pre-set powered adjustment dependent on the proposed performance, suspended within main dome.

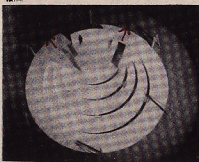
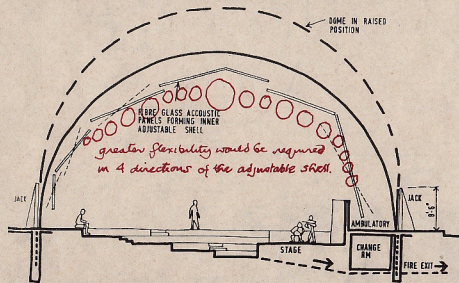
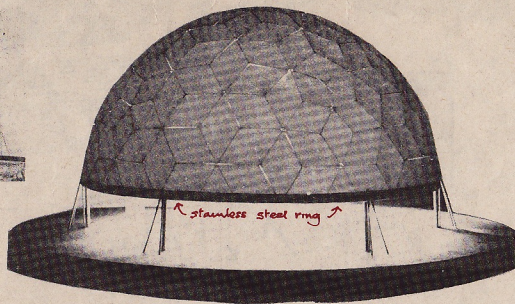
Exhibition The dome is kept raised throughout exhibition times.

cost

£35,000 including £12,000 for dome with steel edge ring.

outline planning permission

Granted September 1962



60	62	AB1	8	21
----	----	-----	---	----

Auditorium - American Museum in Britain Claverton, Bath

General

A combined auditorium for 200 and exhibition area with multi-directional approach and peripheral entry. Designed mainly for use during the months of March to September inclusive. (Additional heating and thermal insulation against frost required for all year usage of the auditorium. Exhibitions could be displayed throughout the year in the present design, since it was decided that their content would be of a durable 'external' nature). The automatic hire of colour-coded clip-on seats with the sale of tickets enabled acoustic positioning of an audience of any number and also ensured the removal of seats after each performance. Minimal performers, facilities provided since the building would work in conjunction with the main building.

The illuminated double dome lowered prior to a performance preventing any late arrivals. Escape routes located either side of the stage utilising the hill-top siting for direct open-air egress. Grassed basin thirty yards from the auditorium, at a slightly lower level and of the same diameter contained concrete seats fitted with external 'localised' loudspeakers. Having been penalised, late arrivals could still enjoy a second-hand hearing of the performance.

COMMENT

Re-use of a redundant Radome with additional stainless steel garter seemed a good idea. All items including the hydraulic jacks could be disassembled and re-sold while the porous amphitheatre filled in and planted. About the maximum size for bothering about tinkering with a dome acoustically. The risk of wind uplift on the dome was never determined. Air tunnel testing would have been useful.

63

61

A13

9

20

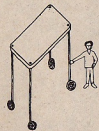
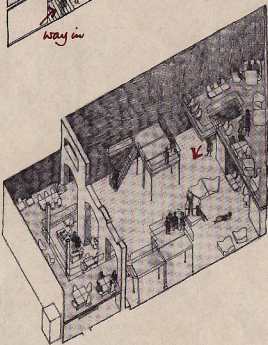
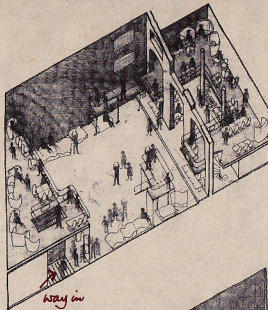
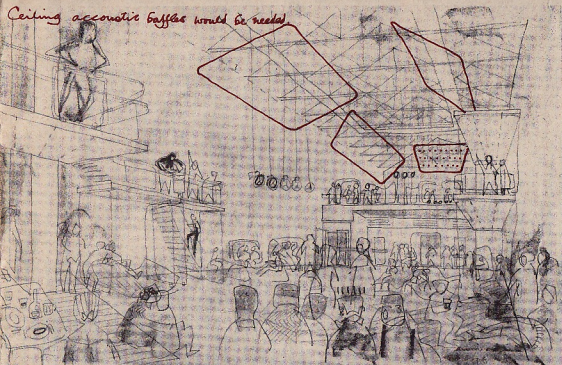
Donmar conversion, London WC1 1963

A project undertaken for the Fun Palace Trust. Located in the Covent Garden area it was intended to provide all night facilities for those who wanted to eat, booze, and lay-about. It was also proposed that during the night impromptu commentaries and reviews of the days news and events should 'happen' Agreement was obtained from those likely to attend to generate such activities. Thus there was an element of random production about the whole scheme. Thus the unit furniture and fittings were designed to enable them to be used individually or in large groupings. The platforms were standard industrial inspection trolleys. In all cases the fittings had to be capable of being moved and grouped by their users. A certain degree of theatrical professionalism was expected amongst the users. The building was, at the time, a rehearsal studio having been originally a banana warehouse.

COMMENT

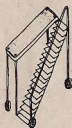
One of many Fun Palace stop-gap efforts aimed at tuning up spatial slums. I have far less interest now in such band-aid acts on individual structures unless the implanted goodies are of a different activital dimension e.g. wiring up Westminster Abbey for family planning advice.

Ceiling acoustic baffles would be needed



real 'primitive' draughting

PLATFORMS

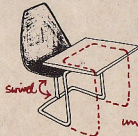


duct trap

CONVERSATION BOX



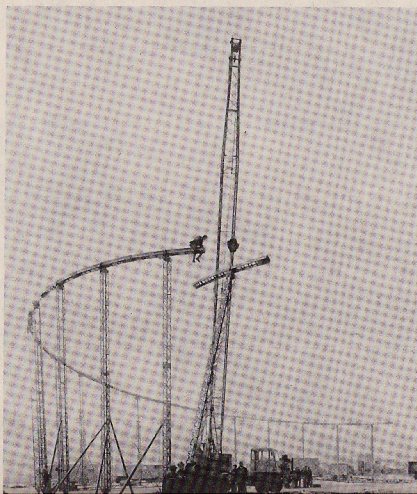
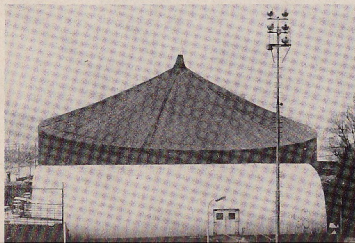
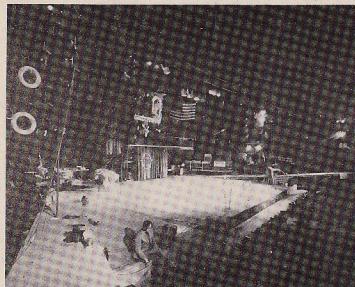
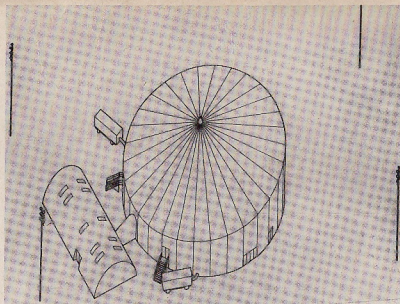
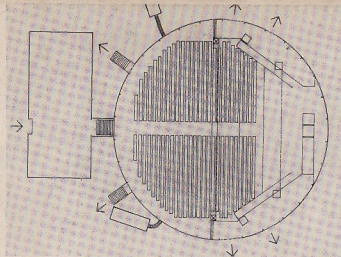
SMALL STAGE



unstable

CHAIR-TABLE





69	96	B12	10	19
----	----	-----	----	----

'Hair' tent theatre - Amsterdam

A period of seven weeks was available from initial design to opening night - January 2 1970. An exercise in assembling a kit of available parts combined with satisfying a slightly conservative local authority on safety requirements.

Tent and heaters purchased from previous mobile Circlorama cinema operators. Stage, lighting towers etc. erected on site on hire. Seating from demolished UK cinema.

Interesting air-freight problems. The tent made originally by Stromeyer required adaptation and a new cover. Major lighting by UK consultants - other effects by Amsterdam 'underground' largely from USA. Essential work from original tent master combined with generous site owner who also owns adjacent Olympic stadium with lighting, bars, lavatories etc. made project possible. Caused through loss of permanent theatre at short notice. Intention to move kit to Italy in nine months time. Cost difficult to determine due to hire charges. Capital cost approx. £20,000. Capacity 1,200 plus full *Hair* cast. Heating, 2 no. 1,000,000 BTU mobile blowers - one on standby.

COMMENT

The brilliant Tent Master (Site Engineer) improved on almost every sequence of work that I had the temerity to suggest. But wait until next time!

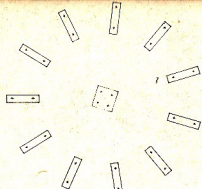
The entrance 'hall' was to be an inflatable structure but although it was acceptable to the authorities, NO European firms could produce in under eight weeks even at such modest dimensions! Some have taken steps subsequently to remedy this absurdity - most have not. However, the real fault is ours - very few manufacturers of air structures have ever received any anticipatory projected use of information from architects. The collection is not moving to Italy as a permanent theatre has been found - the lot is up for sale. The ease of hiring things varies very much from country to country even in Western Europe - remember.

Circular cinema - london

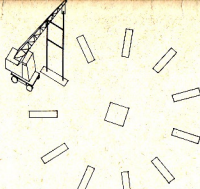
Originally designed for the Piccadilly/Shafesbury Avenue junction site this circular cinema was to house the Russian 360° cinema containing 11 projectors. During the initial design stage, it was decided that the cinema should be portable and capable of about 30 re-sittings - both in UK and Europe. The metal construction was capable of easy trucking and handling - erection and dismantling time being 1-3 days. Costs including erection ranged from £18-20,000 for steel structure and cladding to £24-25,000 for all aluminium. The siting of the projectors, re-wind and sound equipment in the circular continuous gallery reduced projection staff and satisfied safety and fire requirements. In addition it provided a covered gallery at ground level which provided sheltered and heated queuing space as well as siting for the four standard self-contained kiosks - staff rest room; manager/store; electric tickets. All these kiosks were 8 ft wide while the covered arcade was 10 ft in width. The capacity to vary the position of these kiosks as well as the wall panels containing entrance doors enabled sites with very limited peripheral access to be used. It was intended to use local plant and labour for supply. The auditorium was mechanically ventilated through the roof space. The nature of the films and sound track were such that only a medium level of sound insulation was required, considerable dependence for sound masking being put on the siting.

COMMENT

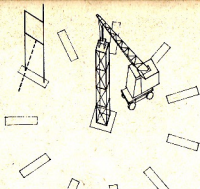
While meeting all statutory requirements on stability, safety etc. the detailing of the components to allow them to be assembled on a wet night by bad-tempered labour would probably have caused major alterations - particularly to the cladding. The art of producing the accurately rough detail is not yet practiced by architects - unfortunately. The packed load had to conform to the section produced when 19th century railway bridges are viewed as the extrusion die.



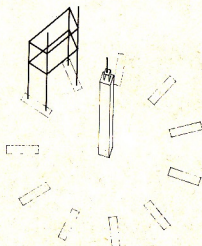
1. Radial concrete bases positioned together with temporary base.



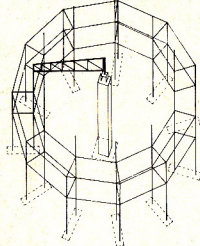
2. First one-piece frame positioned, fixed and temporarily braced.



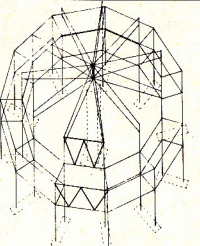
3. Central temporary tower (available for each erection)



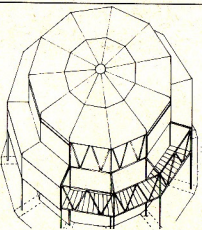
4. Second frame positioned and horizontal ties fixed.



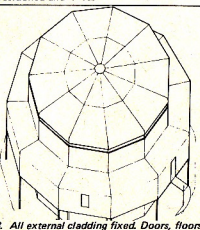
5. All frames and ties fixed. First roof truss positioned and fixed.



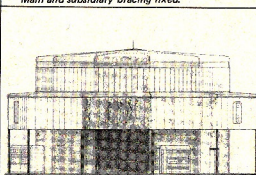
6. All roof trusses fixed. Central tower removed. Main and subsidiary bracing fixed.



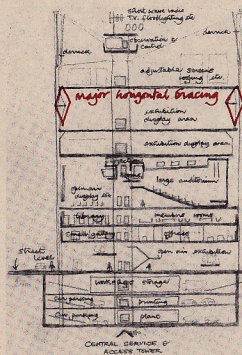
7. All bracing fixed. Floor to projection gallery laid. Internal fire walls fixed. Screens positioned. External cladding applied.



8. All external cladding fixed. Doors, floors, equipment and escape stairs fixed. Complete apart from placing individual kiosks and electrical connections.



Elevation



TOP DECK.
for lighting structures etc.
and future vertical
expansion of total building

GALLERY FLOOR

GALLERY FLOOR

AUDITORIUM,
LECTURE HALLS

LIBRARY & MEMBERS

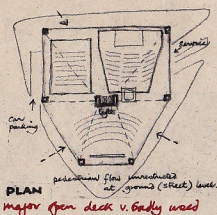
ADMINISTRATION

PUBLIC ENTRANCE
& OPEN TO STREET

SERVICE & STORAGE

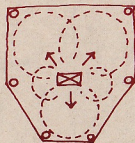
CAR PARKING

SECTION OF
BUILDING

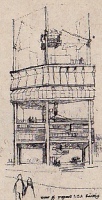


PLAN

possibility for interrelated
temporary enclosures.



possibility for interrelated
temporary enclosures.



63 004 B1 12 00

ICA HQ, South Kensington, London

A very quick look at the possible uses of the South Kensington site for the new ICA. One of numerous investigations done by many about this time with great enthusiasm and little information.

COMMENT

Banal. My interest in 'Over loading' a site caused the stacking of elements of such normality as to be acceptable to any of today's progressive developers. I still like the extendable top floor which though costly could probably be justified due to its secondary use as a lifting maintenance device for the existing structure - during construction and after.

67 X15 C15 13 X

World Museum

An article originally prepared for Sam Edwards of the Arts Magazine (US) which under his unfortunately short editorship was one of the few useful art glossies. Finally published in *Baumeister* June 1968.

The capacity of mankind to preserve, both by intent and through negligence, its artificial dross has been the cause of both museums and slums.

Eventual conscious delight in realising such presence results in free school trips to museums, and architectural band-aid for slums.

In both cases the interest engendered by the object tends to increase with its separation in time and social relevance from the observer. Thus the sculptor, not the stenographer, admires the typewriter at the Museum of Modern Art, while the well-heeled architect sees environmental magic in the tight imagery of slums.

It is felt valid to extend such an investigation to the determination of the degree of conscious planning capable of increasing the availability of the delights and facilities such limited servicing stations at present provide.

It is no longer necessary that artifactual storage and protection be combined with display. In fact, this combination of functions may prove disastrous.
Florence Floods 1966. ▽

dual, not the Fine Arts Committee or the Government.

Policy should be directed towards achieving a new degree of self-space exchange related to the objects. As selection becomes the main organisational drive, so the difference between those who display and those who observe is drastically reduced. A similar reduction in motivational separation occurs in relation to the buildings.

At a rough count, visitors to the museums at Florence are equally divided between those who come for the buildings and those who come for their contents. It is likely that the Guggenheim Museum will soon be able to rid itself of those embarrassing rectangular framed paintings - already Richard Hamilton has turned it into a handleable art object in itself.

Thus they in themselves are becoming the objects - the city, the museum.

Gruesome comparisons can be drawn between the Guggenheim, the Hartford and the Whitney, without knowing what they contain.

This is not a new situation for fully paid-up members of the human race, but it would ▽

Cocoa Beach (Cape Kennedy) seems unnecessary alongside the 'Greatest Show off Earth'.

While the range of particular objects in accessible particular locations increases, their collection under one central roof becomes both less possible and desirable.

The vintage IBM computer can go to the Museum of Modern Art - but that simulated rock covered oil rig should always stay in the middle of Los Angeles - otherwise its lunatic hilarity is lost.

Thus the objects start separating themselves and their very location and adverse environmental qualities become integral with their value.

It is likely that Scotland, if not the whole of the United Kingdom, will in 30 years become primarily an increasingly unbalanced community dedicated to servicing hardy historiophile holidaymakers. Meanwhile, ancient towns become soft intellectual Meccas while hard 19th century towns approach the day when they will become centres of industrial archaeology.

The role of the museum authority is twofold - firstly as an informed manipulative designer

Methods of storage and protection are better suited to providing ideal 'blanket' conditions for groups of artefacts rather than individual 'packaging'. Thus artificial, controlled environments providing maximum security are required, minimising human access

How many people actually touch the gold at Fort Knox?

. . . . and utilising electronic audio-visual methods of information retrieval, comparison and reproduction. Once these links are established then their availability can be increased to such a degree that the service they offer can be included in the range of national or international invisible servicing available to all.

Social security, electricity, credit cards, candy-grams etc.

What then requires to be dispensed in such a way that enables the individual to touch, smell, feel and see directly? Primarily, this question should not be answered by aesthetically-tuned museum curators or 'artier-than-thou' Boards of Governors of Ministers of Culture - it should be answered by the self-paced, free-willed consumers. However, few are going to demand a look at the British Museum's pearl-encrusted Solomon Islanders' navigational chart, since its publicity to date has been rotten. Thus a prime and immediate task of those involved with 'museums' is one of increasing the amount of information on the objects they hold. Only when this work is well advanced can valid decisions be made on where, when and how the goods are made available.

The present argument of whether the British Museum should extend its library into an adjacent site is based on a 19th century mental separation of 'museum' from 'library'. The real question should be whether either is at present offering a central city service.

It is by no means certain that a building as such is required, while to argue the merits of flexibility or permanence of display is almost immaterial. What must be investigated is the methods whereby the organisation, both administrative and spatial, is capable of *distorting* the time and scale required for both recognition and enjoyment - increasing the observers' appetite for self-pace looking, listening, touching and smelling. Whether such activity results in learning, laughter or just lusting about is the concern of the indivi-

appear to be unimaginable to the majority of those concerned with the parsimonious dispensation of past goodies.

'They' still imagine people visit Paris to see the Mona Lisa.

Rapidly the total environment is becoming one's own immediate playground. The need to provide artificial physical stimuli is correspondingly reduced and particularised. Those environments or 'museums' which achieve a socially acceptable distortion are those which extend the range of decision available to the individual.

Disneyland still flourishes, while the miniature United States project flopped. Thus a prime task of the architect/planner/administrator/designer/mayor/police chief is to look at the man-made dross (city/town, suburb) from the point of view of a 'natural' hazard which may have educational/fun/therapeutic qualities as yet unexploited.

Greater facilities for access and informed observation of city demolition sites could well emphasise the 'real' expendability of buildings as opposed to their 'assumed' permanence.

Once again, if a wholly unplanned and near-unconscious way this is already happening.

The Lord Mayor's Show in London and the innumerable processions in New York emphasise the value of the streets in contrast to day-to-day traffic which outlines their criminal shortcomings.

The point is that it is not being consciously encouraged to happen well enough.

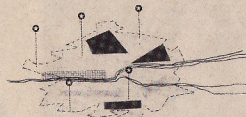
However, if such facilities that existing cities offer are actively and expertly exploited, then, concurrently, the lethal shortcomings of our out-dated environment should be made clear for all to see. One is not suggesting that, because our environment as found can be used as a self-pace museum, we should totally preserve it, and, when pressure demand, reproduce it. Rather one is proposing that the role of the 'museum' is still to select, exploit and then offer for free-will delectation, and that parts of our cities and towns are of use for this only. The physical environment as found - as left-over to us - must become our plaything, but our plaything should only be part of our life.

With increasing social and physical mobility the whole nation, at different times, becomes available as a collection of observable objects.

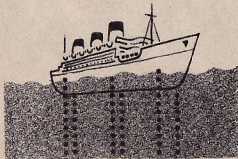
The proposed Disneyland II site at

capable of assessing both existing shortage and excess of available consumable experiences; secondly, it is required to preserve or produce conditions - which may mean buildings or at least enclosures - that recognise and satisfy the increasing capacity of society to change its mind and enjoyable benefit from such a continuous choice pattern.

----- the Museum World becomes the World Museum.



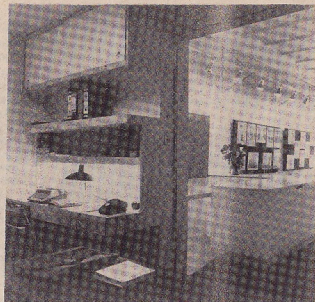
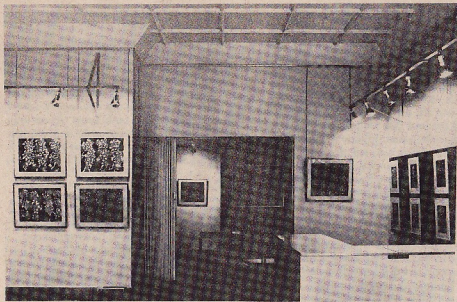
A method to increase the interest and knowledge of the citizens of Glasgow in proposals for their city's development. Free public access to viewing stations at the top of the city - owned buildings is combined - on pre-advertised evenings - with varied colour floodlighting of areas to be demolished, preserved, rehabilitated etc.



A maritime museum for Liverpool using the redundant Queen Mary. The Queen Mary to be permanently positioned offshore held by a series of hydraulic jacks which in a couple of hours could simulate all the extremes of movement experiences on a transatlantic voyage. Visitors would see new relevance in the stylish 30's interior - unknown to most. No additional exhibits would be needed for at least a generation.

COMMENT

A rather long winded article. However, the Queen Mary stunt would have brightened up Liverpool faster and cheaper than its interminable 'face-lift' will. The Glasgow experiment could still be undertaken perhaps from the top of the Post Office Tower. The museum quality of London is rapidly reversing the traditional role of the British Museum.



62	39	B1	14	17
----	----	----	----	----

Robert Fraser Gallery London W1

A conversion from a series of small offices into a single gallery space with an office and basement store and viewing area. An extremely intelligent client enabled early exercises to be done on various forms of lighting and hanging techniques. Finally a simple space for sculpture was selected with vertical display limited to the walls. Storage cabinets, office furniture, desks and stools were included in the design brief. Anodised aluminium was largely used for minimal maintenance. Colours were restricted to black, white and grey throughout. Contract price £2,600. Life span 6 years.

COMMENT

An ideal client who also brought likely exhibitors into the earliest discussions. A good case for skilled shopfitters as main contractors. The contract price included all furniture and special fittings which were manufactured by the contractor. An elaborate earlier artificial lighting grid was rejected against my advice - subsequently Robert Fraser was proved absolutely correct in so doing. It is worth remembering under what conditions the product, in this case ART, will be viewed once purchased. (Illuminators of super-market meat need not agree).

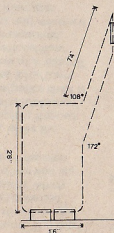
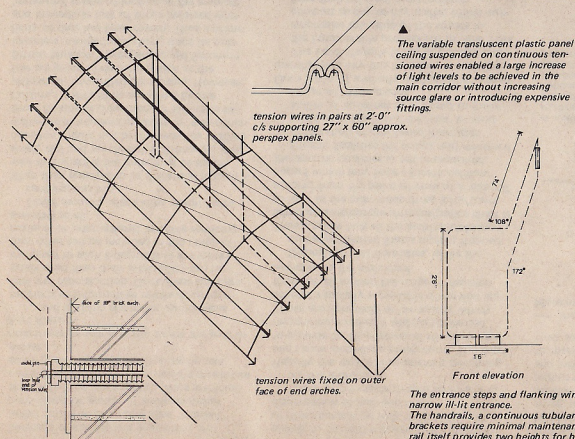
63	52	AB5	15	16
----	----	-----	----	----

Tone Vale Hospital, Somerset

In order to reduce the 19th Century institutional atmosphere various small alterations were undertaken by the works department of this large mental hospital.

COMMENT

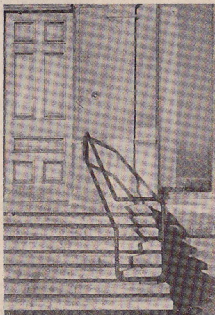
This work caused me to be referred to as 'a dangerous architect' in a Penguin book on hospitals! A small contribution to a desperate situation - the condition of most of our mental hospitals. The lighting behind the translucent ceiling was later subjected to

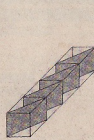
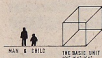
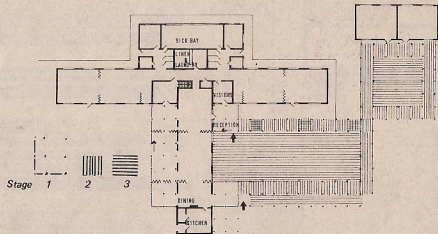
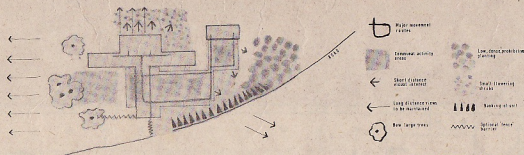


Front elevation

The entrance steps and flanking windows were rebuilt to 'open-up' a previously narrow ill-lit entrance.

The handrails, a continuous tubular steel loop nylon clipped together with bronze brackets require minimal maintenance and enable easy cleaning of the steps. The rail itself provides two heights for hand support.





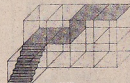
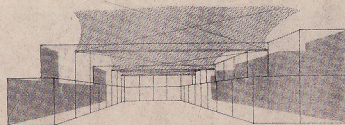
SECOND FLOOR



PLEASED WITH



Pavilion

SUPER ROOM -
KITCHENETTE

LARGE ENCLOSURE,
TEMPERATURE REPRESENTATIVE, WITH ISSUE TO OPEN

Ministerial scrutiny as it exceeded in cost and more important, degree of illumination recommended ten years previously. At first tensioning a brick arch moved - as always in tension structures its the anchorage that is the problem and the cost. The handrail I think good. (J. Starkie Gardner Ltd. and Plastic Coatings Ltd. manufacturers).

64	63	AB5	16	15
----	----	-----	----	----

**Tone Vale children's mental hospital,
Somerset**

The existing rather sad little buildings were insufficient in both volume and delight. A climate of modest uncertainty amongst the staff and doctors in relation to the treatment of mentally sick children encouraged a scheme capable of both variation in use and in ultimate form. It was intended that re-think on the part of the staff could take place between each stage. In addition there was general agreement that the site itself, convenient at the time, might very well be wholly unsatisfactory in the near (10 year) future. Thus the budgeting was for a simple inexpensive limited life kit-of-parts largely capable of construction and erection by the main hospital staff - which included extreme ly skilled wood and metalworkers.

The structure as such, based on an open timber cube capable of being handled by two men. A similar system was employed in the Fun Palace pilot project (AD Nov. 67). The phased development as shown was to enable an increase in partially or wholly projected communal areas while at all times maintaining the capacity for rapid and inexpensive sub-dividing. Whereas Stage 1 merely increased the areas of the existing structures, subsequent stages were intended to encourage a re-think on circulation and use of the whole site.

COMMENT

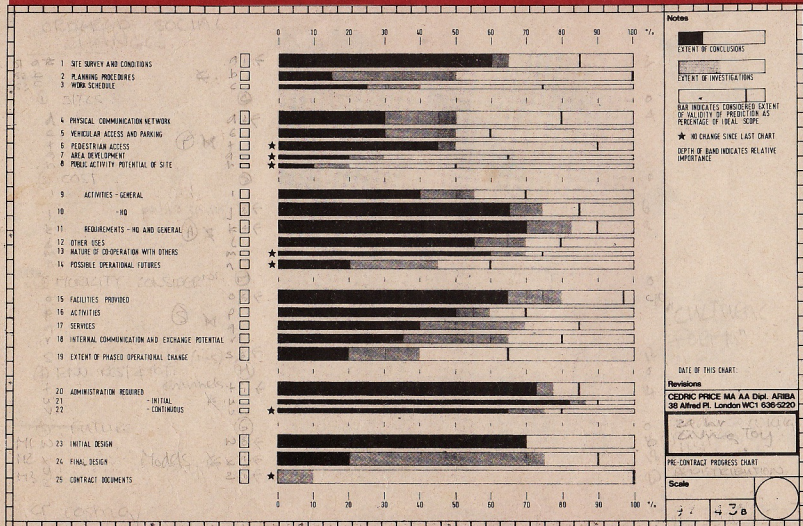
Never built due to lack of funds. My interest in the open handleable box remains but only if it is cheap - otherwise isolated service/structure totem poles are probably more useful. Also there is a limit to the number and interval of vertical poles that can be acceptable - even in a climbing frame or a temple. On explaining the limited life principle it was encouraging to note the change of client appetite from marble to cardboard.

66-

AD3

17

Typical Progress Chart



This chart has been devised to be applicable to any job, although more complex work can require several charts used both concurrently and consecutively. The one illustrated was produced at the start of the initial design for a multi-purpose and multi-occupancy adult learning/entertainment centre. The chart shows my assessment of the maximum percentage of the ideal situation, (ie 100%) that I feel, in the required situation, my office will achieve. It also shows through depth of bar, my design priorities. In addition, where applicable, consultants and clients are given charts all of which have to be updated each month and cross-exchanged.

COMMENT

An extremely painless way of explaining, rapidly at both the inception of work and during its progress, one's own preferences and assessment of capacity of 'success'. No more boring verbal strategy over large meals with strangers who may become clients. It is encouraging to note how clients, public and private, are delighted to join in the chart game and just how skilled they are. Having operated these charts for four years I find them frighteningly useful in determining my appetites and blind spots. (The chart system is my copyright).